

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a newspaper in the UK:

Falling out of love with iPhones?

Apple may be the leading provider of smartphones in China but they announced that they sold 16% fewer iPhones in April 2016 than in April 2015 and made 18% less money from them.

The company said most of the fall was because the Chinese economy was not growing as fast as in the past. China is the second-largest market in the world for Apple products behind the US, and profits in China fell 30%.

In addition to the weak economy, demand for iPhones was also hit by changing fashions. The iPhone is no longer seen as a must have for fashionable young people in China. Asian rivals, which are often cheaper, are now given more equal status.

Researcher Annette Zimmerman wrote last month that the problem was not Apple's alone; pointing out that the price of smartphones in China was still the main problem, even for very inexpensive devices. The majority of Chinese people still cannot afford the price of a smartphone. "Sellers were not able to reduce the price of a 'good enough to use' smartphone lower than US\$50," she said.

Despite the sales decrease, Tim Cook, Apple CEO said "the future of Apple in China is very bright" and promised that the company has some "amazing innovations" for the future.

Your class is doing a project on the topic of "The importance of smartphones in China". You are meeting to discuss the topic. You may want to talk about:

- how smartphones benefit people
- why sales of iPhones did not grow in China in 2016
- whether iPhones will continue to be successful in China
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like Apple iPhones?
2. Are iPhones more popular with young people or older people?
3. Why are people willing to pay a higher price for Apple products?
4. Why do people line up to buy Apple products?
5. Why do you think Apple is so successful?
6. What problems do smartphones cause?
7. Why do people in China like buying American products like the iPhone?
8. How do you think smartphones will change in the future?